



WHY DO SOME PEOPLE HAVE EXTREME BELIEFS?

People with extreme beliefs may not transition easily from one concept to another—a way of thinking known as cognitive inflexibility.

CORE BELIEFS ARE FORMED BY AROUND AGE 7

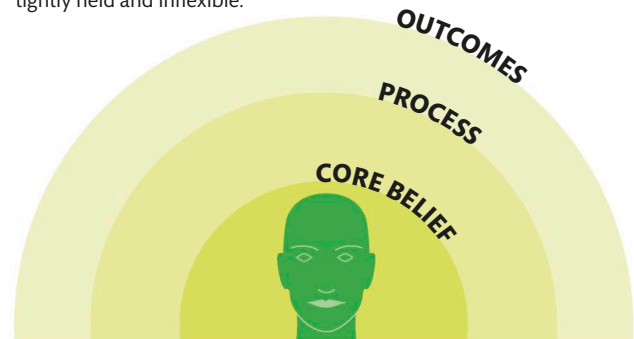


The layers of belief

The deepest layer of beliefs, core beliefs, are the principles that guide our actions (processes). It is our actions that then determine what our outcomes are. When we are looking to make changes in our life, we often focus on outcomes as these are the easiest to change in the short term. However, to foster long-lasting change, we need to change our habits, and to do this, we may need to examine our core beliefs.

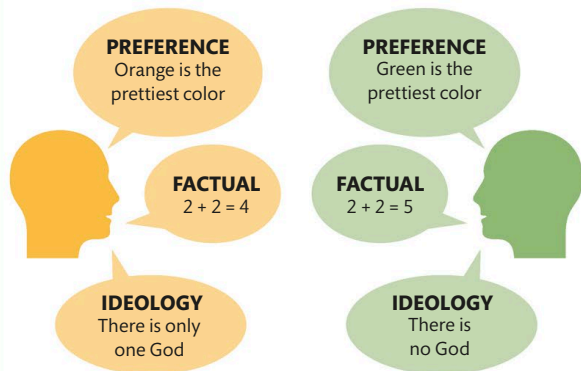
Core beliefs

Your core beliefs are intertwined with how you view yourself and the world around you and are therefore the most tightly held and inflexible.



REASONING BELIEFS

There are three types of beliefs: factual, preference, and ideology. If two people are debating factual beliefs, only one of them can be right, whereas both people can be right in the case of preference. Ideological beliefs draw elements from both fact and preference. Preschoolers can differentiate between these types of beliefs and recognize that, in some cases, two people can be right.



3 Supernatural explanation

As well as spotting patterns, the human brain favors intention over randomness. The idea that lightning was intentionally wielded by gods to punish bad behavior was therefore more satisfying than it being a random natural event.